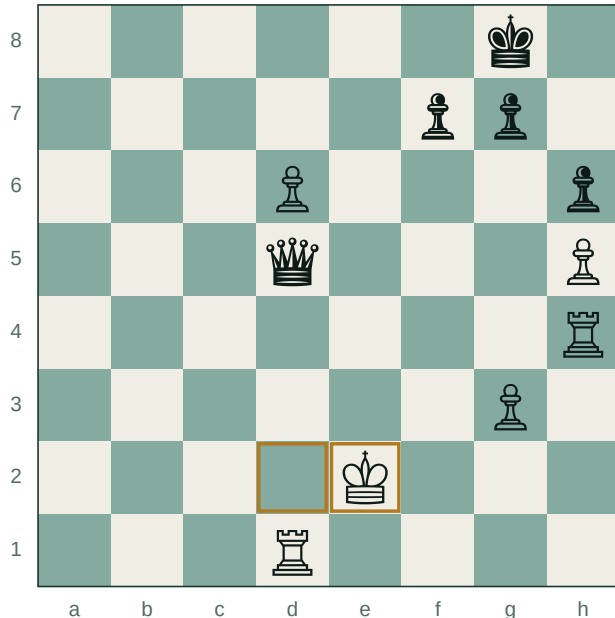


Queen-and-rook endings: Black, move 37

Queen-and-rook endings

Black to move



Previous move: 37.Ke2. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

37...Qg2+ 38. Kd3 Qxg3+

37...Qg2+ Check restricts White to 3 legal replies here. Recorded reply: **38.Kd3**.

38...Qxg3+ Check restricts White to 6 legal replies here. From g3 it attacks king on d3 and rook on h4.

At the end, nominal material is White 12 / Black 12 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +1. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +1:** the balance goes from -1 to +0. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Do not activate the king as casually as in a pure pawn ending. The remaining heavy pieces can still generate a mating net.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

When queens and rooks remain, mating threats coexist with endgame pawn races. Coordination and king shelter remain essential even on a sparse board.

HOW TO LOOK

Look for heavy-piece batteries, skewers, and checks that force a defender away from a promotion square or pawn.

The defending king is on e2. Look for a defender that can be displaced or overloaded.